

10

things that could happen only in India

Ever heard of arms dropping from the sky? Or ghosts being able to read in a country boasting of nearly 65 per cent literacy? No? Then you haven't lived in India.

BHASKAR PAUL



SHANKAR

1 Free Fall Skylab I Falling in India

"A portion of the satellite may fall on the earth with a high impact speed" (INDIA TODAY, September 1978). Since it was speculated that the Skylab may fall in south India, it was not uncommon to see people wearing special helmets to protect themselves from the 2,310-kg airlock shroud. In the end, the spacecraft chose to crash into the Indian Ocean near Australia.



3 False Aid Magic Cure for AIDS

Self-styled ayurvedic doctor T.A. Majeed shot into prominence when he claimed to have cured HIV-positive Chitra Soman and her daughter. He alleged that his findings were "being suppressed for ulterior motives" (INDIA TODAY, August 1993). Soman later died due to full-blown TB as a result of AIDS, and Majeed was never heard of.

2 Dark Tale Wolves of Pavagada

The year 1983 saw a mystery that has remained unsolved till date. Girl children sleeping next to their parents began disappearing in Pavagada in Karnataka. It was alleged that man-eating wolves were behind it all. There were rumours of these being due to "ritualistic sacrifices by a tantrik" (INDIA TODAY, August 1983).



SOLMITRA GHOSH

WHEN LORD GANESHA BEGAN LOVING PUBLIC TREATED IT AS